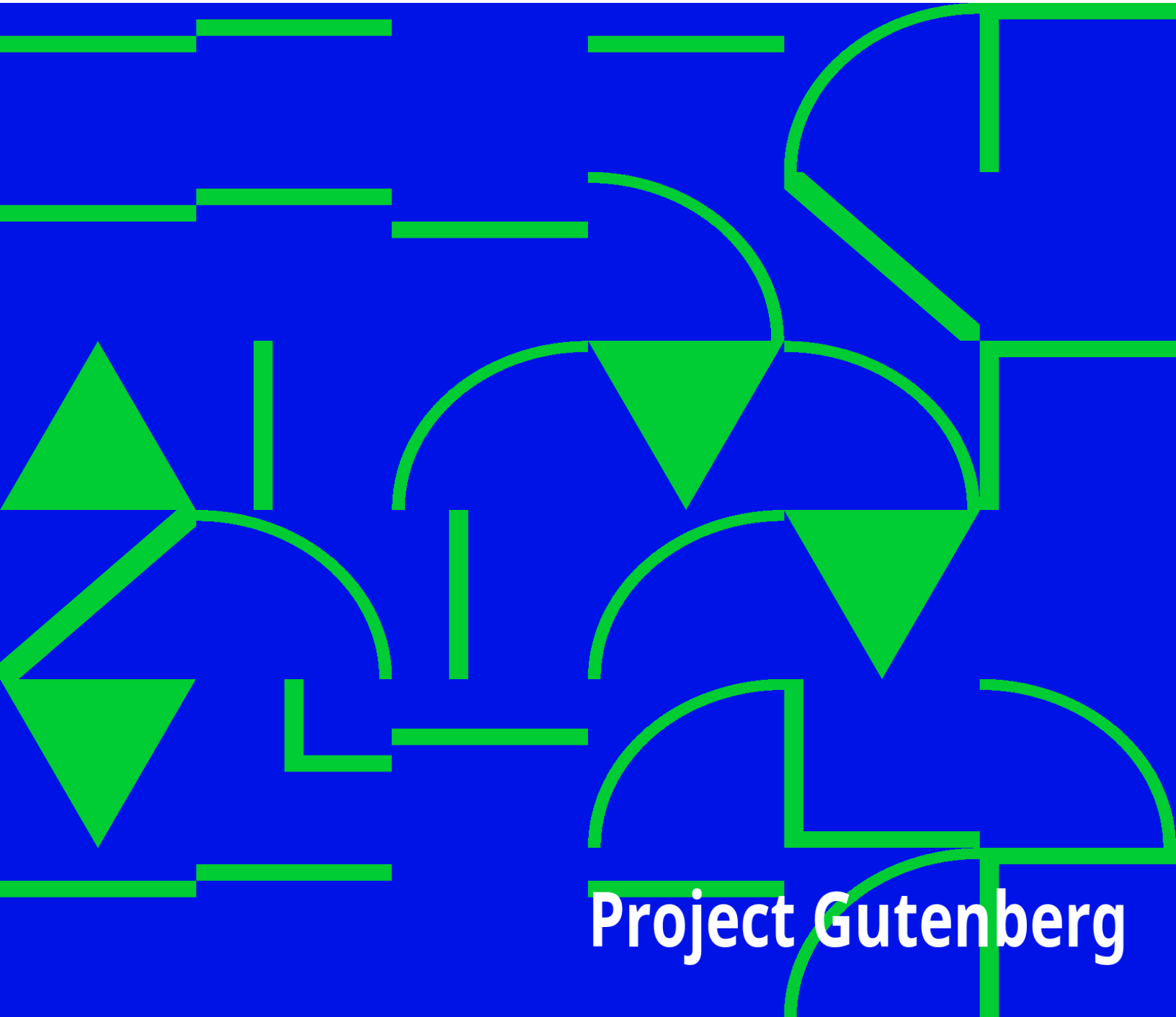
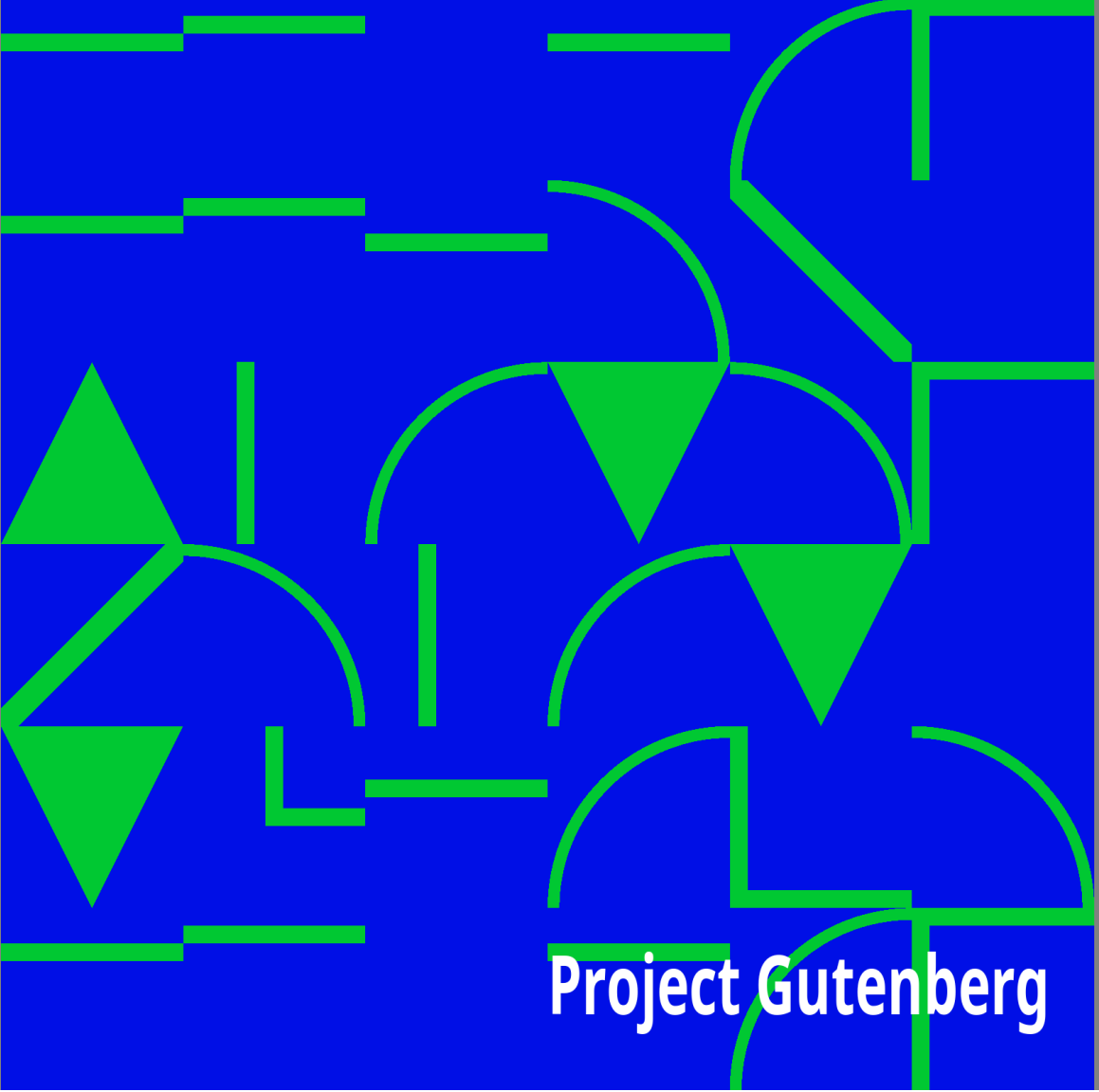


De Duodecim Abusionibus Sæculi



Project Gutenberg

De Duodecim Abusionibus Sæculi



Project Gutenberg

The Project Gutenberg eBook of De Duodecim Abusionibus Sæculi

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: De Duodecim Abusionibus Sæculi

Dubious author: Saint Patrick

Release date: October 4, 2024 [eBook #74516]

Language: Latin

Original publication: Paris: D'Amboise, Pres La Barriere D'Enfer, ou Petit-Montrouge, 1847

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/74516

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DE DUODECIM
ABUSIONIBUS SÆCULI ***

DE DUODECIM ABUSIONIBUS SÆCULI.

TRACTATUS ATTRIBUTI SANCTO PATRICIO, PERPERAM CYPRIANO ET AUGUSTINO ADSCRIPTUS.

CAPUT PRIMUM.

Primus abusiois gradus est, si sine bonis operibus sapiens et prædicator fuerit, qui quod sermone docet, actibus explere negligit. Auditores enim doctrinæ, dicta facere contemnunt, cum prædicatoris opera a prædicationis verbis discrepare conspiciunt. Numquam enim fit efficax constituentis auctoritas, nisi eam effectum operis cordi affixerit audientis, præsertim cum et ipse doctor, si in vitiorum amorem delapsus fuerit, alterius doctoris medicamentum suis vulneribus adhibere parvipendit. Unde et ipse Dominus in Evangelio de doctrina pariter et bono opere instruere volens discipulos, qualem in his cautelam haberent admonebat, dicens: *Quod si sal evanuerit, in quo salietur (Matth. V, 13)?* Hoc est, si doctor erraverit, a quo iterum doctore emendabitur? *Et si lumen, quod in te est, tenebræ sunt; ipsæ tenebræ quantæ erunt (Matth. VI, 23)?* Si namque oculus a videndi officio desierit; quis a manu, vel a pede, vel a reliquo corpore illud ministerium exiget? Quapropter doctores cogitent, ne ampliori vindictæ subiaceant, si plurimis perditionis occasionem abundantius præstent. Nam et ipse Salomon dum multæ sapientiæ transgressionem incurrit, totius Israeliticæ plebis regni dispersionem solius sui merito præstitit. Quibus ergo committuntur multa, majora perdunt; si non recte dispensaverint rectoris sui munera, quæ perceperunt. Cui enim plus committitur ab eo plus exigitur. *Et servus qui domini sui voluntatem intelligens non facit, acrioribus et gravioribus flagellis vindictæ vapulabit (Luc. XII, 47).*

CAPUT II.

Secundus abusiois gradus est, si sine religione senex esse inveniatur. Cui cum membra exterioris hominis veterascunt; vires animi, id est, interioris hominis membra, incrementa roboris non capiunt. Plus enim omnibus

religioni operam dare senibus competit, quos præsentis sæculi florida ætas transacta deseruit. Sicut namque in lignis ipsa reproba arbor comparet, quæ post flores fructus optimos cultori suo non exhibet: sic et in hominibus ipse reprobus est, quem flos juventutis deseruit, et tamen in sui corporis senectute, bonorum operum maturos fructus proferre parvipendit. Quid enim stolidius fieri potest; si mens ad perfectionem festinare non contendat, quando totius corporis habitus senectute confectus ad interitum properat? Dum oculi caligant, aures graviter audiunt, capilli fluunt, facies in pallorem mutatur, dentes lapsi numero minuuntur, cutis arescit, flatu non suaviter olet, pectus suffocatur, tussis cachinnat, genua trepidant, talos et pedes tumor inflat; etiam homo interior qui non senescit, his omnibus aggravatur. Et hæc omnia ruituram jamjamque domum corporis cito prænuntiant. Quid ergo superest, nisi ut dum hujus vitæ defectus appropinquat, nihil aliud cogitare quam quomodo futura habitatio prospere comprehendatur, quisque senex appetat? Juvenibus enim incertus hujus vitæ terminus instat, senibus vero cunctis maturior ex hac luce exitus breviter concordat. Cavendæ sunt ergo homini duæ particulæ, quæ in illius carne non veterascunt, et totum hominem secum ad peccatum pertrahunt; cor videlicet et lingua: quia cor novas semper cogitationes machinari non desinit; lingua impigre loquitur, quodcumque machinari cor senserit. Caveat ergo senilis ætas, ne istæ juvenescentes particulæ totam sui harmoniam decipiant, et per res ineptas reliqui corporis gravitatem illudant. Unicuique enim considerandum est, quid ætate eminenti dignum sit; ut hoc agat, quod nec vitam, nec ætatem, nec ministerium vile reddat.

CAPUT III.

Tertius abusiois gradus est, adolescens sine obedientia; quo mundus a recte rationis ordine depravatur. Qualiter namque in senectute aliis ministerium imperabit, qui in adolescentia se senioribus obedientem exhibere contemnit? Unde et in proverbio apud veteres habetur, quod dominari nequeat, qui prius alicui servitutem præbere denegat. Propter quod et Dominus Jesus in temporibus suæ carnis, dum adhuc ad legitimam ætatem doctoris non pervenerat, obedienter ministrationem parentibus suis præstitit. Sicut ergo in senibus sobrietas, et morum perfectio requiritur: ita etiam in adolescentibus, obsequium, et subjectio, et obedientia rite debetur. Quapropter et in mandatis legis primum in his quæ ad homines pertinent,

patris et matris honor imperatur, quia quamvis carnalis pater non supervixerit, aut indignus fuerit; alicui tamen patri digno et viventi, paternus honor usque ad dignam ætatem a filiis præbendus esse ostenditur. Quatuor etenim modis per Scripturas divinas patres vocantur; hoc est, natura, gente, admonitione, et ætate. De patre namque naturali Jacob ad Laban loquitur: *Nisi timor patris mei Isaac adfuisset, tulisses omnia quæ mea sunt* (Gen. XXXI, 42). Gente vero pater dicitur, quando Dominus de rubo ad Moysen loquebatur: *Ego sum*, inquit, *Deus patrum tuorum, Deus Abraham, Deus Isaac, Deus Jacob* (Exod. III, 6). Ætate autem et admonitione pariter pater dicitur, cum Moyses in cantico Deuteronomii loquitur: *Interroga patrem tuum, et annuntiabit tibi; majores tuos, et dicent tibi* (Deut. XXXII, 7). Quod si ergo naturalis pater superstes non fuerit, aut indignus fuerit; admonenti tamen aut seniori adolescentis obedientia præbenda erit. Quomodo ergo honoratus in senectute apparebit, qui disciplinæ laborem in adolescentia non sustinuerit? Quodcumque etenim homo laboraverit, hoc et metet. *Omnis namque disciplina in præsentī non videtur esse gaudii, sed mæroris; postea vero fructum pacatissimum exercitatio per eam reddet justitiæ* (Heb. XII, 11). Sicut ergo fructus non invenitur in arbore, in qua pampinus aut flos prius non apparuerit: sic et in senectute honorem legitimum assequi non poterit, qui in adolescentiæ disciplinæ alicujus exercitatione non laboraverit. Disciplina igitur absque obedientia, qualiter fieri potest? Adolescens ergo sine disciplina, adolescens sine obedientia est: quoniam et ipsa obedientia, quæ omnium disciplinarum mater est, magna exercitatione indiget; quæ sui normam studii in Christo Domino sumpsit, qui obediens patri usque ad mortem, crucis ignominiam libenter sustinuit.

CAPUT IV.

Quartus abusio est, dives sine elemosyna; qui superflua usus sui quæ custodienda in posterum recondit, indigentibus et nihil habentibus non distribuit: per quod efficitur, ut dum in terra quæsitā diligenti cura custodit, cœlestis patriæ perennem thesaurum amittat. Ad quem thesaurum Dominus Jesus adolescentem divitem, qui cum de perfectione interrogaverat, ita respondens invitavit: *Si vis perfectus esse, vade et vende omnia quæ habes, et da pauperibus, et veni, sequere me, et habebis thesaurum in cælo* (Matth. XIX, 21). Quem thesaurum nullus umquam hominum habere potest, nisi qui

pauperibus solatia præstat, aut per seipsum pauper est. Non ergo dormiat in thesauris tuis, quod pauperes dormire non sinit. Dives namque etsi multa congregaverit, his frui solus nequaquam poterit; quia unius hominis natura multis rebus non succurrit. Quid ergo stultius est quam propter unius hominis victum et vestitum, totam regni cœlestis perdere perennem jucunditatem, et æternos inferni cruciatus, absque consolationis præstolatione subire? Quod igitur aliquando per necessitatem amittendum est, pro æterna remuneratione sponte distribuendum est. *Omnia enim quæ videntur, temporalia sunt, quæ non videntur æterna sunt* (II Cor. V, 18). Quamdiu namque temporales sumus, temporalibus temporalia deserviunt, et cum hinc transierimus, æternis æterna solatia præstabuntur. Idcirco non debemus diligere ea quæ non semper habebimus; præsertim cum expertem rationis avarum divitem, thesauri sui et agri, et omnia quæ habet, ostendant; quia toto cordis intuitu illas res amat quæ numquam se diligunt. Si enim aurum et argentum, et agros, et vestimenta, et cibos, et metalla, et bruta animalia quis dilexerit, hæc omnia vicem sibi amoris rependere non posse, ipsa rerum natura ostendit. Quid ergo a ratione longius est quam diligere, quod te amare non valet; et negligere illum, qui tuæ dilectioni cum dilectione omnia præbet? Propter hoc igitur non diligi mundus, sed diligi proximus a Deo præcipitur; quia proximus vicem sui amoris potest rependere, quod mundus minime posse non dubitatur. Sic enim inimicum esse diligendum Dominus præcepit, ut illa dilectio amicum illum ex inimico efficiat. Quisquis ergo dives cupidus vult æternas habere divitias, distribuendo egenis præstet interim non mansuras. Si enim quod diliget non vendit, nemo potest emere quod cupit. Avari namque ideo in iudicio a rectissimo iudice nuncupantur maledicti, quia qui præteribant eorum habitacula non dicebant: *Benedictio Domini super vos, benediximus vobis in nomine Domini* (Psal. CXXVIII, 8). Infelices ergo sunt avari divites, qui propter res transitorias, in æternam damnationem dilabuntur; et e contrario: *Beati sunt misericordes, quia misericordiam consequentur* (Matth. V, 7). Felix est ergo misericors, dum in hac virtute non substantiam, sed affectum Deus requirit.

CAPUT V.

Quintus abusionis gradus est, femina sine pudicitia. Sicut enim omnes bonos mores procurat et custodit in viris prudentia, sic et in feminis cunctos

honoris actus nutrit et fovet et custodit pudicitia. Pudicitia namque castitatem custodit, avaritiam refrænât, lites devitat, iram mitigat, libidinem occupat, cupiditatem temperat, lasciviam castigat, ebrietatem cavet, verba non multiplicat, gulæ concupiscentias purgat, furtum omnino damnat. Quid plura? Omnia vitia restringit; et omnes virtutes, et quidquid coram Deo et bonis hominibus laudabile est nutrit. Impudica namque vita nec laudem ab hominibus in præsentî sæculo, nec remunerationem a Deo exspectat in futuro. Pudica vero vita, famam bonam inter homines habet, et de spe futuræ beatitudinis gaudet. Præsentibus semetipsam imitabilem facit, posteris memoriam amabilem relinquit. Bonis semper moribus delectatur et consentit, et assiduis Scripturarum meditationibus et eloquiis animam vegetat. Bonorum præcedentium exempla custodit, et inseparabilia perfectis contubernia nectit. Duobus ergo modis constat veræ pudicitiae exercitatio, id est corporis habitu et superficie et animi affectu inferno. Per exteriorem modum coram Deo, providemus opera bona. Pudicitia namque corporis est, alienas res non appetere, et omnem immunditiam devitare, ante horam congruam non gustare velle, risum non excitare, verba vana et falsa non loqui; habitum per omnia ordinatum, compositionemque convenientem tam capillorum quam vestium, sicut decet, habere; cum indignis contubernia non inire; supercilioso intuitu neminem aspicere, vagari oculos non permittere; pompatico et illecebroso gressu non incedere; nulli inferior in incæpto bono opere apparere, nulli contumeliam aut ruborem incutere, neminem blasphemare, senes non irridere, bonis non invidere, meliori non controversari; de his quæ ignoras, non tractare, et ea quæ scis non omnia proferre: hæc enim proximis amabilem hominem reddunt, et Deo acceptabilem faciunt. Pudicitia enim animæ est, plus propter Dei oculos quam hominum omnia bona facere; appetitiones turpium cogitationum compescere; omnes meliores se esse æstimare, nemini invidere; de semetipso nihil confidere, Dei semper auxilio res omnes committere, ante Dei oculos semetipsum constituere, hæretica pravitate sensum non maculare, catholicis per omnia consentire; Deo soli adhærere, castitatem æternæ mentis Deo Christo offerre; omnia cæpta opera bona mortis tantum termino finire; præsentis tribulationes animi fortitudine negligere, parvipendere; in terra præter proximos nihil amare, cuncti amoris thesaurum in cœlo constituere, et pro omni bono actu mercedem a Deo in cœlestibus sperare. Pudicitia ornamentum nobilium est, exaltatio humilium, nobilitas ignobilium, pulchritudo debilium, prosperitas laborantium,

solamen mærentium, augmentum omnis pulchritudinis, decus religionis, defensio criminum, multiplicatio meritorum, creatoris omnium Dei amicitia.

CAPUT VI.

Sextus abusiois gradus est dominus sine virtute, quia nihil proficit dominandi habere potestatem, si dominus ipse non habeat virtutis rigorem. Sed hic virtutis rigor, non tam exteriori fortitudine, quæ et ipsa sæcularibus dominis necessaria est, quam animi interiori fortitudine, exerceri debet. Sæpe enim dominandi per animi negligentiam perditur fortitudo, sicut in Heli sacerdote factum fuisse comprobatur; qui dum severitate iudicis peccantes filios non coercuit, in eorum vindictam, Dominus velut consentienti ferociter non pepercit. Tria ergo necessaria hos qui dominantur habere oportet: terrorem scilicet, et ordinationem, et amorem. Nisi enim ametur dominus pariter et metuatur, ordinatio illius constare minime potest. Per beneficia ergo et affabilitatem procuret ut diligatur, et per justas vindictas, non propriæ injuriæ, sed legis Dei, studeat ut metuatur. Propterea quoque, dum multi pendent in eo, ipse Deo adhærere debet, qui illum in ducatum constituit; qui ad portanda multorum onera, ipsum veluti fortiorem solidavit. Paxillus enim nisi bene fortiter firmetur, et alicui fortiori adhæreat, omne quod in eo pendet cito labitur; et ipse solutus a rigore suæ firmitatis, cum oneribus ad terram delabitur. Sic et princeps nisi suo Conditori pertinaciter adhæserit, et ipse, et omne quod continet, cito depeirit. Quidam namque per dominandi officium plus Deo appropinquant, quidam imposito sibi dignitatis honore deteriores fiunt. Moyses namque, accepto populi ducatu, familiaris Dei locutionibus utebatur: Saul vero, filius Cis, postquam sceptrum regni suscepit, per inobedientiæ superbiam Deum offendit. Rex Salomon postquam patris sui David sedem obtinuit, Deus illum ultra omnes mortales velut ad innumerosi populi gubernationem sapientiæ munere ditavit. E contrario vero Hieroboam, servus Salomonis, postquam regni domus David occupavit partem, ad idolorum cultum decem tribus Israel, quæ erant in parte Samariæ, diverterat. Per quæ exempla evidenter ostenditur, quosdam in sublimiori statu ad majorem perfectionem crescere, quosdam vero per supercilium dominationis ad deteriora defluere. Per quod utrumque intelligitur eos qui ad meliora transcendunt, per virtutem animi et Dei auxilium posse id facere, et eos qui ad deteriora devertuntur,

per mentis imbecillitatem pariter et negligentiam errare. Unde et dominum absque virtute fieri non decet, qui virtutem sine Dei auxilio nullatenus habet. Qui etenim multa tuetur, si non habet fortitudinem animi, non valet id agere, quoniam magna magnis infestationibus, vel adversitatibus solent laborare. Omnis ergo qui præest, hoc primitus animi tota intentione procuret, ut per omnia de Dei adjutorio omnino non dubitet. Si namque cœperit in actibus suis auxiliatorem habere Dominum dominorum, nullus hominum contemptui poterit habere ejus dominatum: *Non enim est potestas nisi a Deo (Rom. XIII)*. Ipse enim elevat de stercore egenum, et sedere facit cum principibus populi sui, et deponit potentes de sede, et exaltat humiles; ut subditus fiat omnis mundus Deo et egeat gloria Dei.

CAPUT VII.

Septimus abusiois gradus est Christianus contentiosus, qui, cum participationem nominis Christi per fidem et Baptismum suscepit, contra Christi dicta et propositum, mundi caduca delectamenta diligit. Omne enim de quo contenditur, aut propter propriam ejus rei dilectionem de qua agitur, aut propter alterius amorem, quæ sub odiosa specie latet, appetitur. Quemadmodum, verbi gratia, bellum animoso compugnantium conflictu cum odiosa res sit, propter amorem victoriæ et libertatis peragitur; et multæ aliæ dilectæ species, sub odioso labore vel formidine, satis contentiose expetuntur. Unde patenter intelligitur nihil contendere posse, nisi propter dilectionem, speratam scilicet et subsequentem amabilem remunerationem. Qui igitur de mundo præsentem ex quacumque causa contendit, perspicue ostendit quod illum diligit. Quomodo ergo mundum diligi per Joannem Spiritus sancti sermones interdiciunt, qui ait: *Nolite diligere mundum, neque ea quæ in mundo sunt (I Joan. II, 15)*. Mundi enim amor et Dei pariter in uno corde cohabitare non possunt, quemadmodum iidem oculi cælum pariter et terram nequaquam conspiciunt. Sed requirendum est si vere in mundo aliquid sit quod amari debeat, et quis sit ille mundus, quem diligi divina eloquia vetant. Terra ergo cum nascentibus ex ea, et metallis, et animantibus, et pulchritudine vestium, et oblectationibus ciborum, et iis quæ ad hæc pertinent, non diligi præcipitur; sed proximus, propter quem hæc omnia facta sunt, amari jubetur. Hæc enim omnia prædicta, velut non mansura, ad cœlestem patriam pergentes concomitari nequeunt. Proximi vero velut mansuri regis cohæredes, semetipsos licenter invicem diligunt.

Quod ergo semper in mundo non manet, et cum mundo pariter deficiet, et ipse mundus non amari præcipitur; proximus autem, qui est pars regni cœlestis, in terra et inter ima elementa, a regni cœlorum appetitoribus non incongrue amatur, dum in suprema illa patria in æternum cohæres habebitur. Propterea vero mundus præsens non diligi imperatur, ne a Dei dilectione alienus, sæculi dilector quisque efficiatur. Non ergo debet contendere, quod non licet amari. Igitur Christianus, qui nominis Christi similitudinem tenet, morum quoque ejus similitudinem habere debet. Christianus enim nemo recte dicitur, nisi qui Christo moribus coæquatur. De Christo vero per Prophetam ita scribitur: *Ecce filius meus quem elegi, electus meus, complacuit in illo sibi anima mea: ponam Spiritum meum super eum. Non contendet, neque clamabit, neque audiet aliquis in platea vocem ejus* (Is. XLII, 1; *Matth.* XII, 18). Ecce Christus non contendit, neque clamavit: et tu si morum Christi similitudinem tenere cupis, ne contendas, ne abusivus in Ecclesia Christianus existas. Suis enim sectatoribus Christus præcepit: *Nolite vocari rabbi; unus est enim pater vester, qui in cœlis est. Omnes enim vos fratres estis* (*Matth.* XXIII, 8), quibus ad supplicandum imperavit, cum dicit: *Sic autem orabitis: Pater noster qui in cœlis, sanctificetur nomen tuum* (*Matth.* VI, 9). Frustra ergo contendit patrem se habere in terra, qui patrem et patriam profitetur se habere in cœlo. Cujus patriæ nemo possessor efficitur, nisi qui de terrenæ patriæ contentione securus habetur.

CAPUT VIII.

Octavus abusiois gradus est, pauper superbus, qui, nihil habens, in superbiam extollitur: cum e contrario divitibus sæculi non superbe sapere per apostolum Paulum imperetur. Quid ergo stolidius potest fieri quam illum qui per infirmam miseriam velut in terram abjectus, extremus et humilis incedere et contristari debuerat, supercilioso superbiæ tumore inflatam mentem contra Deum erigere? Per quod vitium lapsi corruerunt, qui in summo cœli conditi erant culmine. Quid ergo vult quasi potens in terra superbire, qui præ omnibus hominibus debuerat humilis apparere? Sed, ne de paupertate sua tristitiam habeant, quid a Deo recepturi sint pauperes attendant; ipse enim inquit: *Beati pauperes spiritu, quoniam ipsorum est regnum cœlorum* (*Matth.* V, 3). Recta namque dispensatione misericors iudex cœli regnum illis committit quibus regni terrarum participationem inter mortales abstulit, ut ipse dives in cœli sede appareat

qui in terra penitus nihil procurat. Cavendum ergo pauperibus est ne, dum per egestatem et necessitatem terrenum regnum prætereunt, per mentis etiam impudentiam cœlorum regna amittant. Cum enim Dei dispensatione paupertatem necessariam acceperunt, in ipsorum arbitrio pendet utrum pauperes spiritu sint. Non quibuscumque namque pauperibus cœli regna promittuntur, sed his tantummodo in quibus divitiarum inopiam animorum humilitas comitatur. Pauper enim humilis pauper spiritu appellatur, qui, cum egenus foris cernitur, numquam in superbiam elevatur: quoniam ad appetenda regna cœlorum plus valet mentis humilitas, quam præsentium divitiarum temporalis paupertas. Etenim humiles qui bene divitias possessas habent, possunt pauperes spiritu appellari: superbos autem nihil habentes, haud dubium est beatitudine paupertatis privari. De quibus utrisque sancta Scriptura ita loquitur: *Est quasi dives nihil habens, et est quasi pauper, cum in multis divitiis sit* (Prov. XIII, 7). Quasi pauper ergo in multis divitiis est dives humilis spiritu; et nihil habens quasi dives est pauper superbus mentis affectu. Nobilis ergo inopia est mentis humilitas, et ineptæ divitiæ sunt animorum enormitas. Providendum est ergo pauperibus, ut semetipsos, quales sint, intelligant; et quia rebus consequi quod cupiunt non valent, mentis tumore superbire desinant.

CAPUT IX.

Nonus abusiois gradus est, rex iniquus. Etenim regem non iniquum, sed correctorem iniquorum esse oportet. Inde in semetipso nominis sui dignitatem custodire debet: nomen enim regis intellectualiter hoc retinet, ut subjectis omnibus rectoris officium procuret. Sed qualiter alios corrigere poterit, qui proprios mores, ne iniqui sint, non corrigit? quoniam in justitia regis exaltatur solium, et in veritate regis solidantur gubernacula populorum. Justitia vero regis est neminem injuste per potentiam opprimere, sine personarum acceptione inter virum et proximum suum juste judicare, advenis et pupillis et viduis defensorem esse, furta cohibere, adulteria punire, iniquos non exaltare, impudicos et histriones non nutrire, impios de terra perdere, parricidas et pejerantes vivere non sinere, ecclesias defendere, pauperes eleemosynis alere, justos super regni negotia constituere, senes et sapientes et sobrios consiliarios habere, magorum, ariolorum pythonissarumque superstitionibus non intendere, iracundiam differre, patriam fortiter et juste contra adversarios defendere, per omnia in

Deo confidere, prosperitatibus animum non elevare, cuncta adversa patienter tolerare, fidem catholicam in Deum habere, filios suos non sinere impie agere, certis horis orationibus insistere, ante horas congruas cibum non gustare. *Væ enim terræ cuius rex puer est, et cuius principes mane comedunt (Eccle. X, 10).* Hæc regni prosperitatem in præsentī faciunt, et regem ad cœlestia regna meliora perducunt. Qui vero regnum non secundum hanc legem dispensat, multas nimirum adversitates imperii tolerabit. Idcirco enim pax sæpe populorum rumpitur, et offendicula etiam de regno suscitantur, terrarum quoque fructus diminuuntur, et servitia populorum præpediuntur, multi et varii dolores prosperitatem regni inficiunt, charorum et liberorum mortes tristitiam conferunt, hostium incursus provincias undique vastant, bestię armentorum et pecorum greges dilacerant: tempestates aeris et hyemis terrarum fœcunditatem et maris ministeria prohibent, et aliquando fulminum ictus segetes et arborum flores et pampinos exurunt. Super omnia vero regis injustitia, non solum præsentis imperii faciem offuscat, sed etiam filios suos et nepotes, ne post se regni hæreditatem teneant, obscurat. Propter piaculum enim Salomonis, regnum domus Israel Dominus de manibus filiorum ejus dispersit. Et propter justitiam David regis, lucernam de semine ejus semper in Hierusalem reliquit (III Reg. XI, 31-35). Ecce quantum justitia regis sæculo valeat, intuentibus perspicue patet. Est enim pax populorum tutamen patriæ, immunitas plebis, munimentum gentis, cura languorum, gaudium hominum, temperies aeris, serenitas maris, terræ fœcunditas, solatium pauperum, hæreditas filiorum, et sibimet ipsi spes futuræ beatitudinis. Attamen sciat rex quod, sicut in throno hominum primus constitutus est, sic et in pœnis, si justitiam non fecerit, primatum habiturus est. Omnes namque quoscumque peccatores sub se in præsentī habuit, supra se modo implacabili, in illa pœna futura habebit.

CAPUT X.

Decimus gradus abusio est episcopus negligens; qui gradus sui honorem inter homines requirit, sed ministerii sui dignitatem coram Deo, pro quo legatione fungitur, non custodit. Primum namque ab episcopo, quid sui nominis dignitas teneat, inquiratur, quoniam, cum episcopus nomen græcum sit, speculator interpretatur. Quare vero speculator ponitur, et quid a speculatore requiritur, Dominus ipse denudat, cum sub Ezechielis prophetæ

persona, episcopo officii sui rationem denuntiat, ita inquit: *Speculatorem dedi te domui Israel. Audiens ergo ex ore meo sermonem, nuntiabis eis ex me. Si autem videris gladium venientem, et tu non annuntiaveris ut revertatur impius a via sua, ipse quidem impius in iniquitate sua morietur, sanguinem autem ejus de manu tua requiram. Si autem tu annuntiaveris, et ille non fuerit reversus, ipse quidem in iniquitate sua morietur, sed tu animam tuam liberasti* (Ezech. III, 17). Decet ergo episcopum, qui omnium speculator positus est, peccata diligenter attendere, et postquam attenderit, sermone, si potuerit et actu corrigere; si non potuerit, juxta Evangelii regulam, scelerum operarios declinare: *Si enim, inquit in Evangelio Dominus, peccaverit in te frater tuus, corripe illum inter te et ipsum solum. Si te audierit, lucratus eris fratrem tuum: si te non audierit, adhibe tecum adhuc unum vel duos testes, ut in ore duorum vel trium testium stet omne verbum: si illos non audierit, dic Ecclesiæ: si Ecclesiam non audierit, sit tibi sicut ethnicus et publicanus* (Matth. XVIII, 15). Tali ordine expellendus est quicumque doctori vel episcopo adhærere noluerit. Et qui tali ordine expulsus fuerit, ab alio aliquo doctore vel episcopo non debet recipi. De sacerdote namque scriptum est in lege: *Viduam aut repudiatam non accipiat uxorem* (Levit. XXI, 7). Qui ergo illum excommunicatum a catholico, illo non permittente, sibi jungit, jura sacerdotii sancti, in quo Christianorum genus electum est, excedit. Hac ratione episcopum, ad eos quibus in speculationem positus est, esse oportet. Cæterum vero, qualis in semetipso esse debeat, Paulus apostolus exponit: ut ad gradum episcopi veniens sit sobrius, prudens, castus, sapiens, modestus, hospitalis, filios habens subditos cum omni castitate, testimonium habens bonum ab his qui foris sunt, proferens doctrinæ fidelem sermonem; antequam episcopus sit, non plures habens uxores quam unam; non percussor, non bilinguis, non ebriosus, non neophytus, ut per hæc ipse ostendat in opere, quod alios docet in sermone doctrinæ (I Tim. III, 2). Caveant ergo negligentes episcopi quod in tempore vindictæ Dominus per Prophetam conqueritur, dicens: *Pastores muti demoliti sunt populum meum, et non pascebant gregem meum pastores, sed pascebant semetipsos* (Ezech. XXXIV, 8); sed potius procurent hi quos constituit Dominus super familiam suam, dare illis cibum in tempore suo mensuram tritici, puram scilicet et probatam doctrinam, quatenus veniente Domino mereantur audire: *Euge, serve bone et fidelis, quia supra pauca fuisti fidelis, supra multa te constituam: intra in gaudium domini tui* (Matth. XXV, 23).

CAPUT XI.

Undecimus abusiois gradus est plebs sine disciplina, quæ, cum disciplinæ exercitationibus non servit, communi se perditionis laqueo constringit: iram etenim Domini absque disciplinæ rigore non evadit. Atque idcirco Psalmistæ vocibus indisciplinatæ plebi prædicatur: *Apprehendite disciplinam, ne quando irascatur Dominus* (Psal. II, 12). Disciplina vero morum est ordinata correctio et majorum præcedentium regularum observatio. De qua disciplina Paulus apostolus ita loquitur dicens: *In disciplina perseverate; tamquam filiis vobis offert se Deus. Quod si extra disciplinam estis, cujus participes facti estis? Omnes enim adulteri, et non filii estis* (Hebr. XII, 8). Qui ergo adulteri, sine disciplina sunt, et cœlestis regni hæreditatem non capiunt: si filii autem paternæ disciplinæ correctiones ferunt, et hæreditatem quandoque recipere posse non desperent. De qua etiam disciplina Esaias quidem indisciplinatæ plebi prædicat, dicens: *Quiescite agere perverse, discite bene facere* (Isa. I, 16). Et ad eandem Psalmista consona voce compallit, dicens: *Declina a malo, et fac bonum* (Psal. XXIII, 15). Infelix ergo est qui abjicit disciplinam. Audet enim extra milites aliquid qui, Dominum crucifigentes, non ejus sciderunt tunicam, qui Ecclesiæ Christi scindit disciplinam. Sicut enim tunica totum corpus præter caput tegitur, ita disciplina, omnis Ecclesia, præter Christum, qui caput est Ecclesiæ et sub disciplina non est, protegitur et ornatur. Ipsa vero tunica contexta desuper fuerat per totum, quia eadem disciplina Ecclesiæ a Domino de cœlo tribuitur et integratur. De qua Dominus cum ad Patrem ascendisset, postquam resurrexit a mortuis, ad Apostolos suos loquebatur, dicens: *Vos autem sedete hic in civitate, quoadusque induamini virtute ex alto* (Luc. XXIV, 49). Tunica ergo corporis Christi disciplina Ecclesiæ est: qui autem extra disciplinam est, alienus est a corpore Christi. *Non scindamus igitur illam, sed sortiamur de illa cujus sit* (Joan. XIX, 24); id est, non solvamus quidquam de mandatis Domini, sed unusquisque in quo vocatus est, in eo permaneat apud Dominum.

CAPUT XII.

Duodecimus abusiois gradus est populus sine lege, qui, dum Dei dicta et legum scita contemnit, per diversas errorum vias eundem perditionis laqueum incurrit. De quibus viis sub persona prævaricatoris populi,

humanum genus Propheta ita deplangit: *Nos autem sicut oves erravimus, unusquisque in viam suam declinavit* (Isa. LIII, 6), de quibus viis etiam Sapientia loquitur per Salomonem: *Multæ viæ videntur hominibus rectæ, et novissima earum deducunt ad mortem* (Prov. XIV, 12). Quæ utique multæ perditionis viæ tunc inceduntur, cum una regalis via, lex Dei videlicet, quæ neque ad dexteram neque ad sinistram declinat, per negligentiam deseritur. De qua scilicet via Dominus Jesus Christus, qui est finis legis ad justitiam omni credenti, denuntiat: *Ego sum via, veritas et vita, neque venit ad Patrem nisi per me* (Joan. XIV, 6). Ad quam viam omnes homines communiter invitat, dicens: *Venite ad me, omnes qui laboratis et onerati estis, et ego reficiam vos* (Matth. XI, 28); *quia non est personarum acceptio apud Deum* (Rom. II, 11), ubi non est Judæus, nec Græcus, masculus et femina, servus et liber, barbarus et Scythia, sed omnia in omnibus Christus: omnes enim unum sunt in Christo Jesu. Dum ergo Christus finis legis est, qui sine lege sunt, sine Christo fiunt. Igitur populus sine lege, populus sine Christo est. Abusivum ergo in temporibus Evangelii populum sine lege fieri, quando Apostolis in cunctas gentes licentia prædicationis data est, quando tonitruum Evangelii per cunctas sæculi partes intonuit, quando Gentes quæ non sectabantur justitiam, apprehenderunt justitiam; quando qui de longe fuerant, facti sunt prope in sanguine Christi: qui aliquando non populus, nunc autem populus Dei in Christo; quando est tempus acceptabile, et dies salutis, et tempora refrigerii in conspectu Altissimi; quando unaquæque gens habet testem resurrectionis; quando ipse Dominus protestatur, dicens: *Ecce ego vobiscum sum omnibus diebus usque ad consummationem sæculi* (Matth. XXVIII, 20). Non itaque simus sine Christo in hoc tempore transitorio, ne sine nobis Christus esse incipiat in futuro.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK DE DUODECIM
ABUSIONIBUS SÆCULI ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.